

(12) **United States Patent**
Tortorella, Jr.

(10) **Patent No.:** **US 12,406,598 B2**
(45) **Date of Patent:** **Sep. 2, 2025**

(54) **LICENSE PLATE HOLDER**

(71) Applicant: **Frank Joseph Tortorella, Jr.**, Park Ridge, IL (US)

(72) Inventor: **Frank Joseph Tortorella, Jr.**, Park Ridge, IL (US)

(*) Notice: Subject to any disclaimer, the term of this patent is extended or adjusted under 35 U.S.C. 154(b) by 0 days.

(21) Appl. No.: **18/765,304**

(22) Filed: **Jul. 7, 2024**

(65) **Prior Publication Data**

US 2024/0363035 A1 Oct. 31, 2024

Related U.S. Application Data

(63) Continuation of application No. 18/357,135, filed on Jul. 23, 2023, now Pat. No. 12,033,543, which is a continuation of application No. 17/607,370, filed as application No. PCT/US2019/029789 on Apr. 30, 2019, now Pat. No. 11,710,426.

(51) **Int. Cl.**
B60R 13/10 (2006.01)
G09F 7/18 (2006.01)
G09F 9/30 (2006.01)
G09F 13/18 (2006.01)

(52) **U.S. Cl.**
CPC **G09F 7/18** (2013.01); **G09F 9/30** (2013.01); **G09F 13/18** (2013.01); **B60R 13/105** (2013.01); **G09F 2007/1895** (2013.01)

(58) **Field of Classification Search**
CPC ... G09F 7/18; G09F 9/30; G09F 13/18; G09F 2007/1895; G09F 21/04; B60R 13/105
See application file for complete search history.

(56) **References Cited**

U.S. PATENT DOCUMENTS

2,697,889 A * 12/1954 Heim G03B 21/64 40/706
5,870,841 A * 2/1999 Brody, II B60R 13/105 40/643
6,550,172 B2 * 4/2003 Korpai G06F 1/1607 40/725
7,415,787 B2 * 8/2008 Eidsmore B60R 13/105 40/201
12,077,107 B1 * 9/2024 Ramirez G09F 7/18
2005/0093684 A1 * 5/2005 Cunnien B60Q 1/56 348/148
2008/0098629 A1 * 5/2008 Graham B60R 13/10 40/201

* cited by examiner

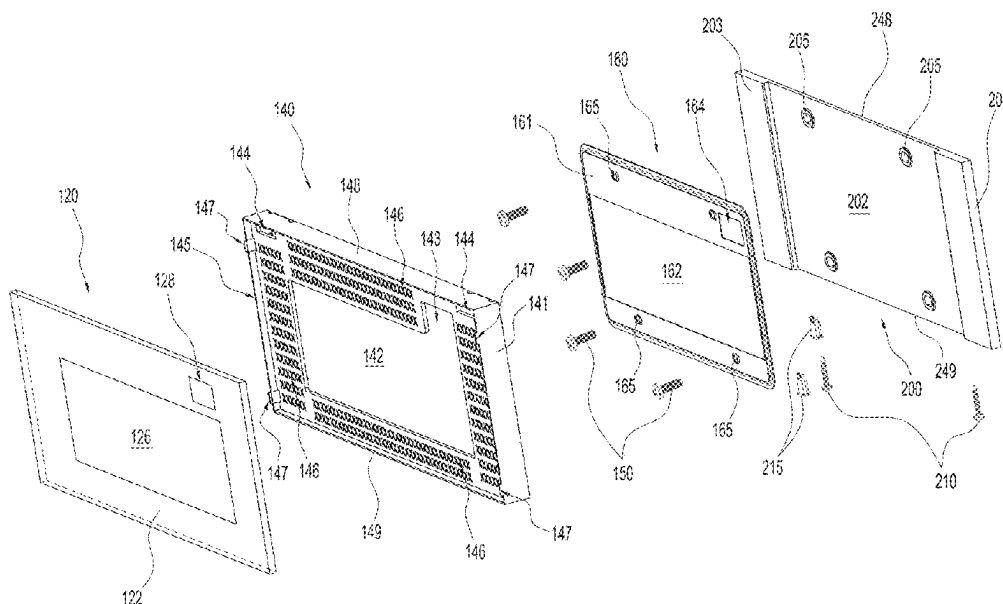
Primary Examiner — Cassandra Davis

(74) *Attorney, Agent, or Firm* — MARSHALL, GERSTEIN & BORUN LLP

(57) **ABSTRACT**

A license plate holder includes a frame defining a central opening to permit display of indicia on at least one license plate display region of a license plate and defining frame display region(s) adjacent the central opening and a transmissive substrate. The transmissive substrate includes snap-fit connectors to connect the transmissive substrate to peripheral portions of the frame to dispose the transmissive substrate over the central opening and the frame display region(s). In an assembled stated with the transmissive substrate disposed in front of the frame and connected to the frame, a central region of the transmissive substrate is positioned over the central opening and the license plate display region and a peripheral region of the transmissive substrate is positioned over the at least one frame display region.

19 Claims, 9 Drawing Sheets



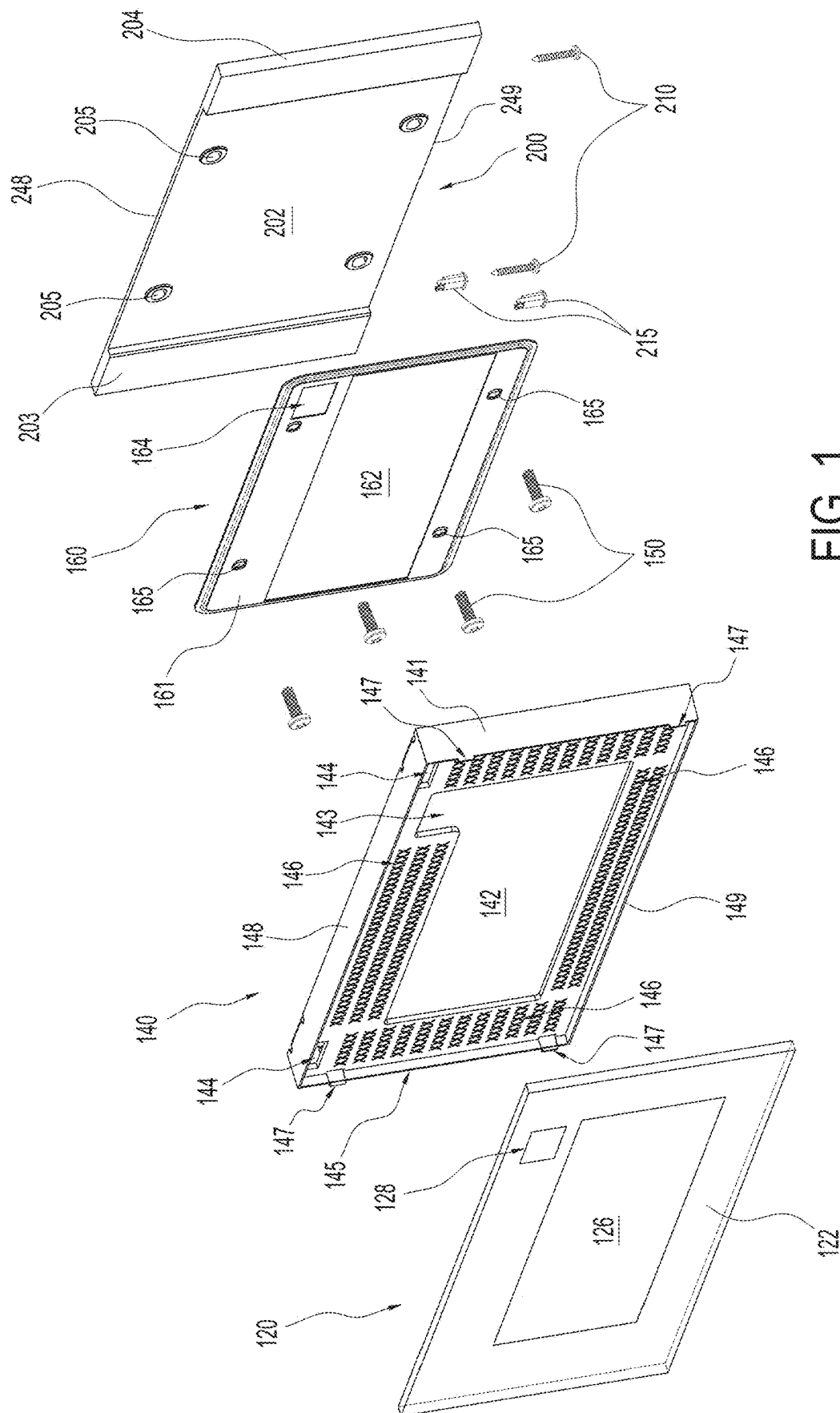


FIG. 1

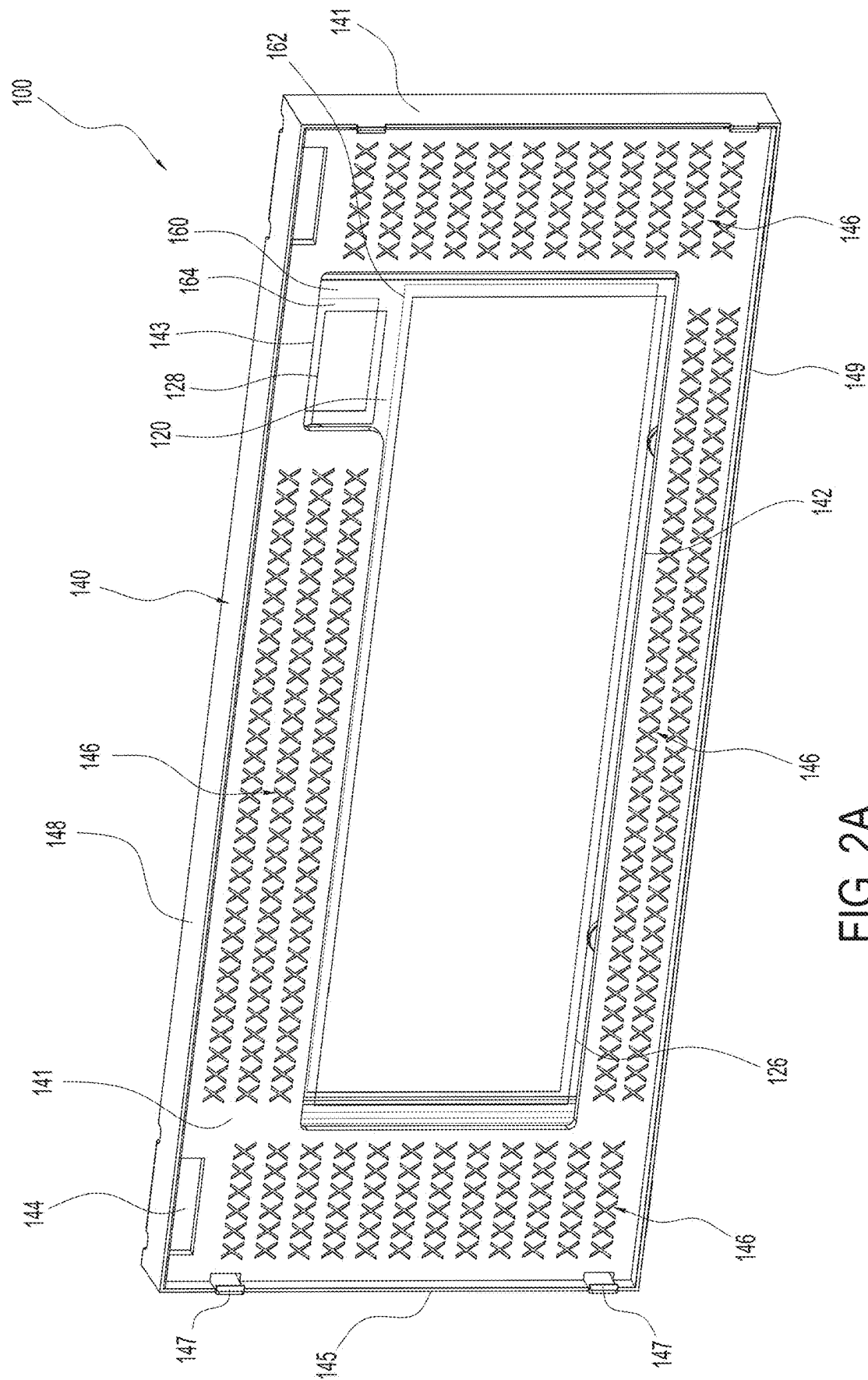


FIG. 2A

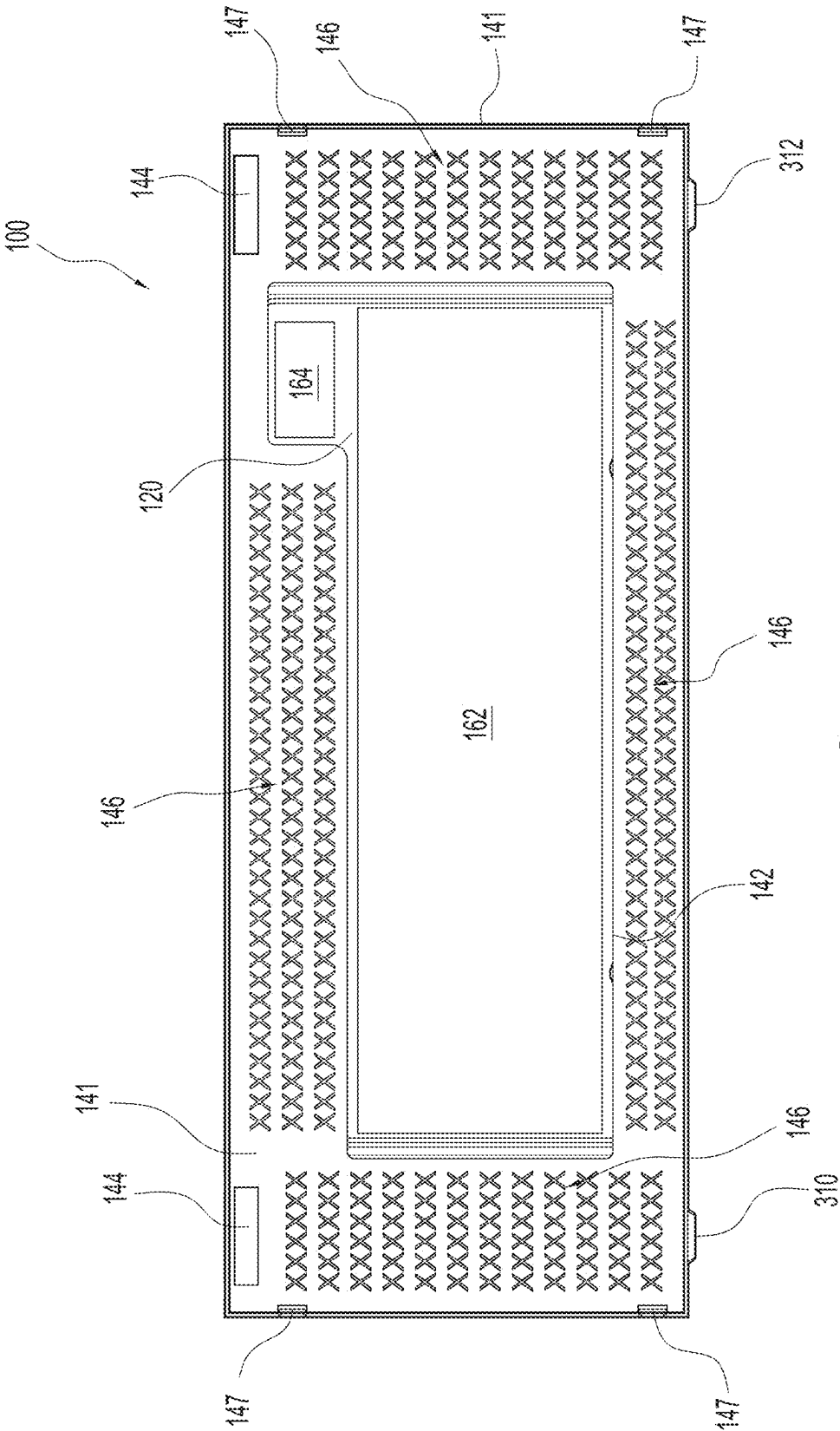


FIG. 2B

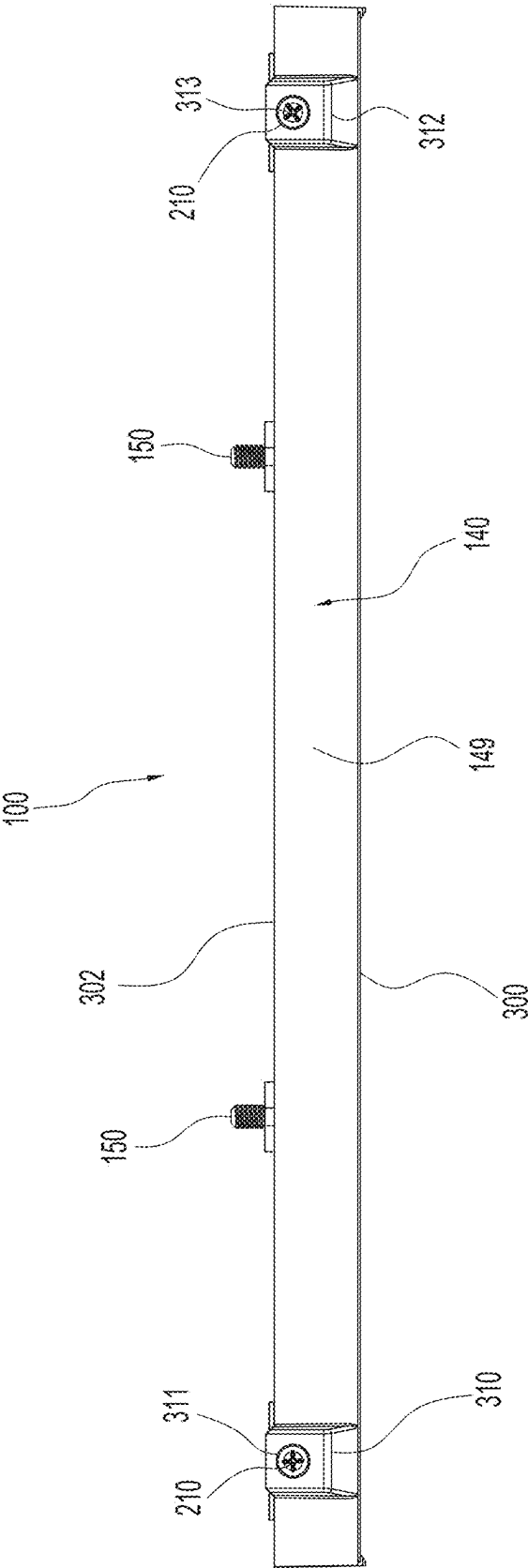


FIG. 3

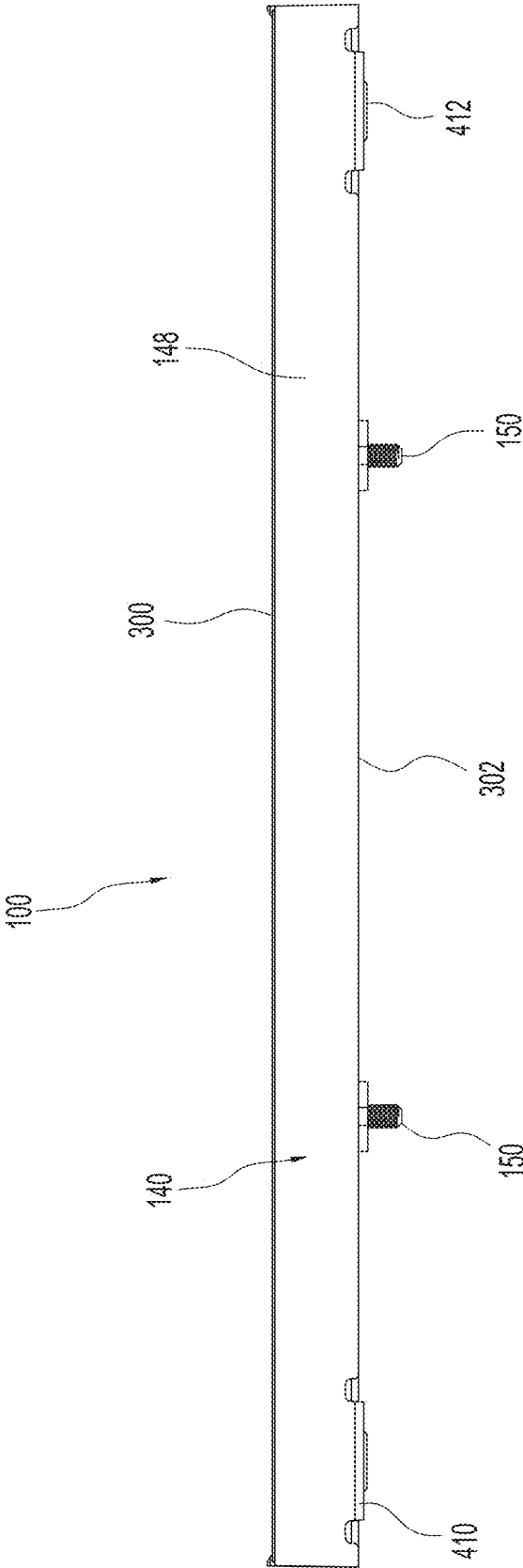
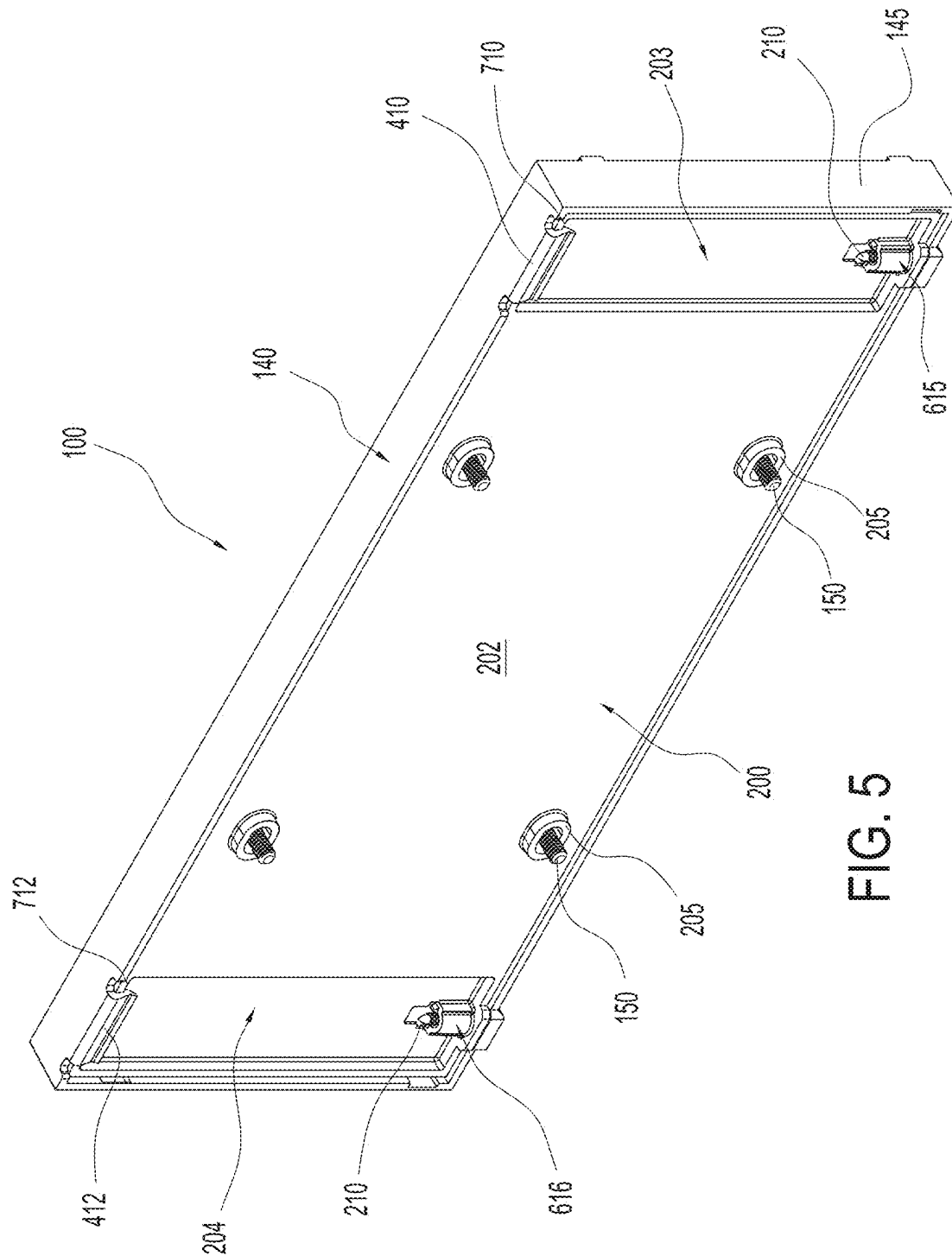
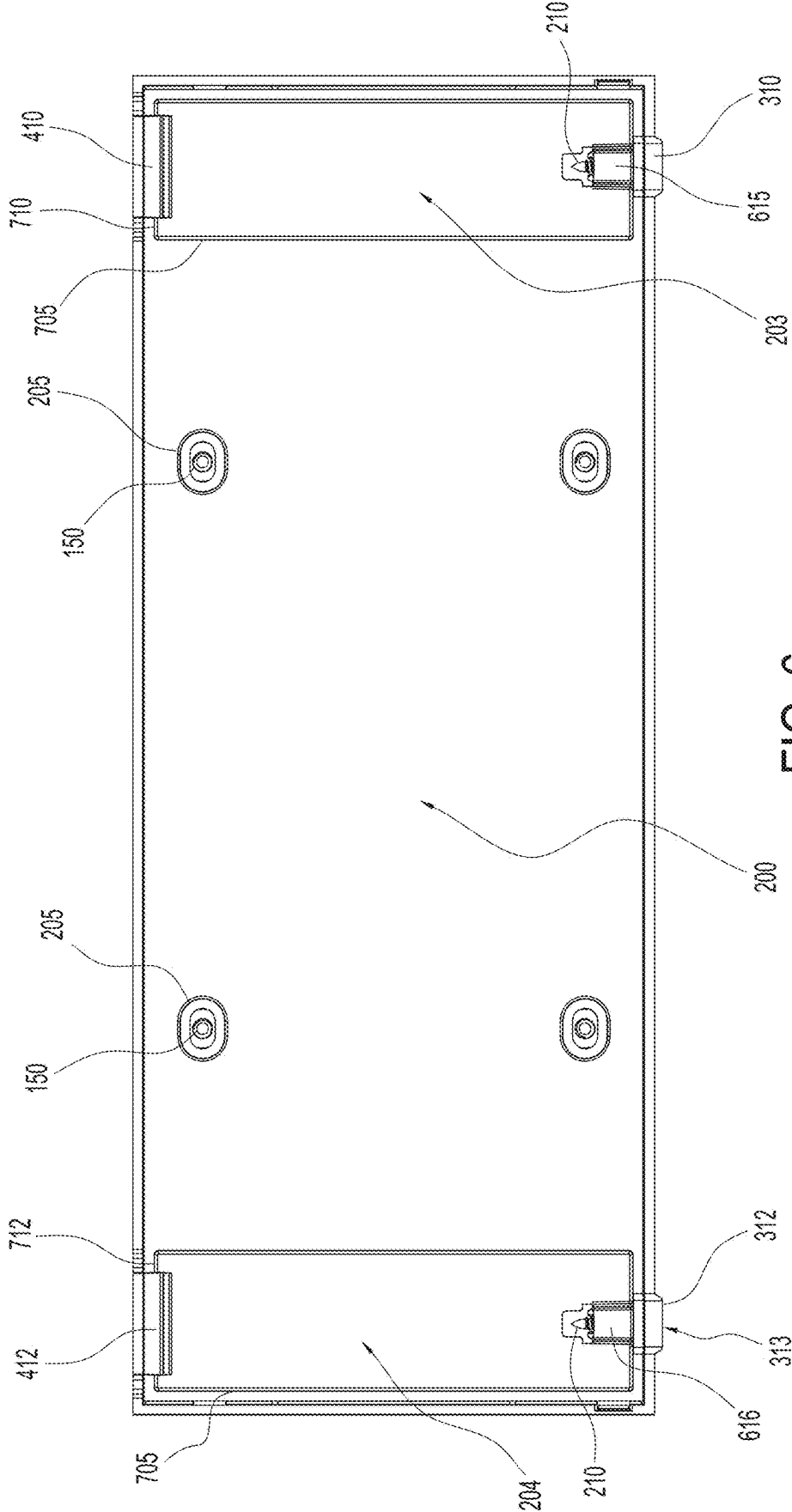


FIG. 4





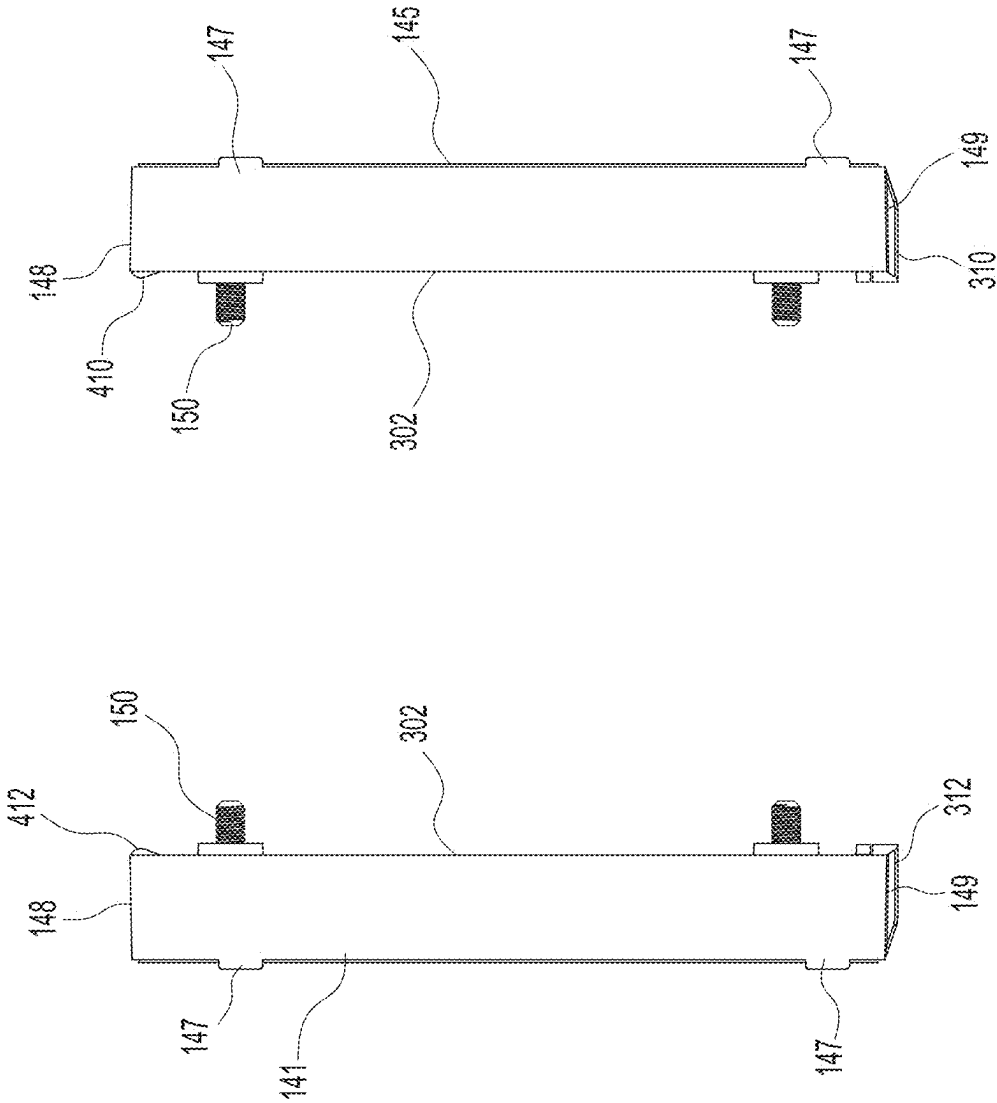


FIG. 7B

FIG. 7A

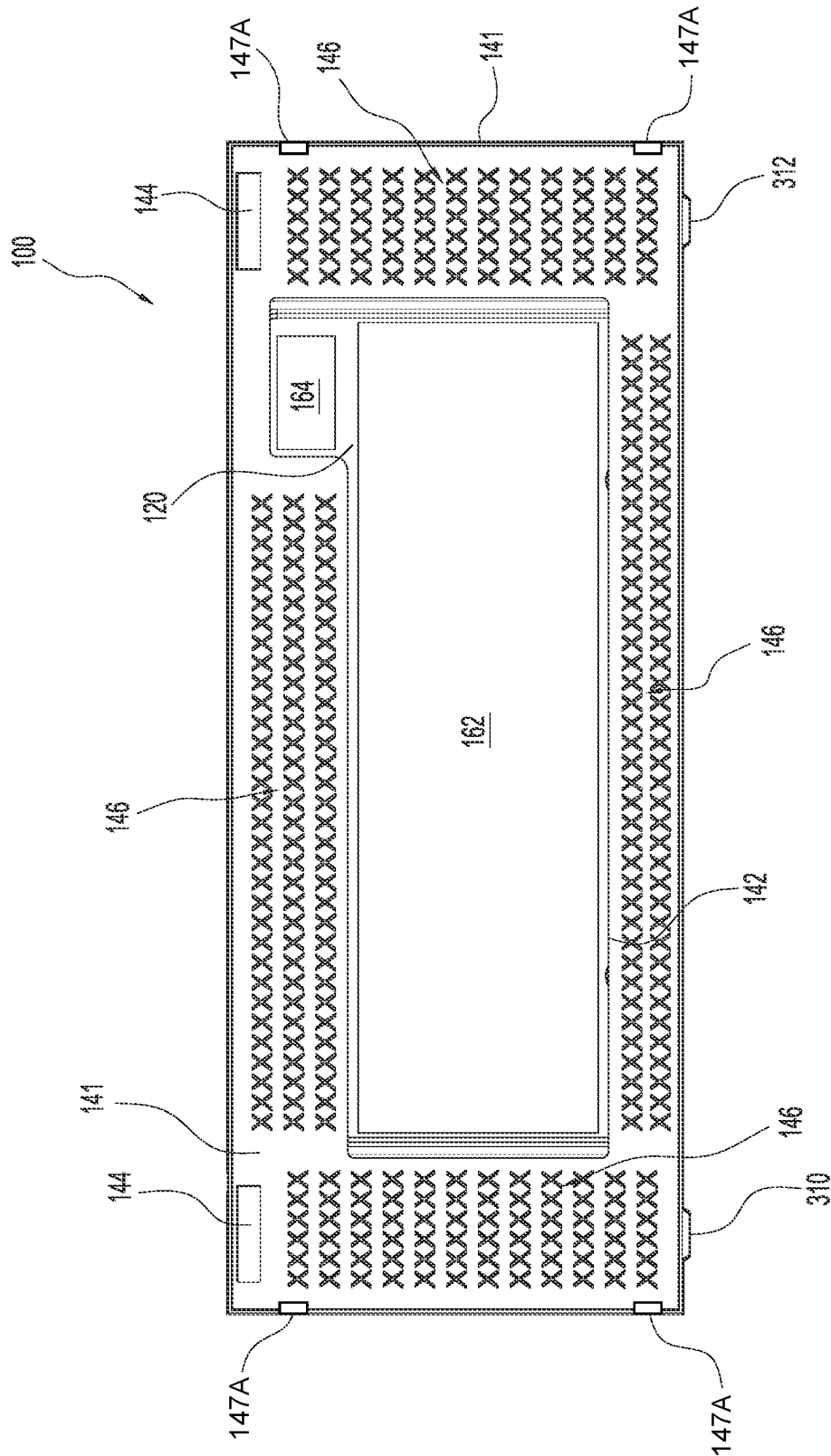


FIG. 8

LICENSE PLATE HOLDER

BACKGROUND

A vehicle registration plate, also known as a number plate (British) or a license plate (American), is a metal or plastic plate attached to a motor vehicle or trailer for official identification purposes. All countries require registration plates for road vehicles such as cars, trucks, and motorcycles. The registration identifier is a numeric or alphanumeric ID that uniquely identifies the vehicle owner within the issuing region's vehicle register. In various examples, license plates may be 305 mm×152 mm (12.0"×6.0") (the United States), 520 mm×110 mm (20.5"×4.3") (various European countries), or 440 mm×140 mm (17.3"×5.5") (China). License plates may be formed from a variety of materials, such as plastic or metal (e.g., aluminum, steel, an alloy, etc.).

To secure the license plate to the vehicle, a license plate holder or license plate frame is used to hold the license plate and is itself attached to the vehicle, typically by screws that mount into threaded fittings on the vehicle. The license plate holder is configured to ensure that the license plate numbers and regulatory stickers are not obscured. License plate holders are often made from a metal (e.g., stainless steel, aluminum, etc.) or plastic, and may have a protective coating applied thereover.

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

FIG. 1 is an exploded perspective view of an example license plate holder in accord with at least some of the present concepts.

FIG. 2A is a perspective view of the example license plate holder of FIG. 1 in an assembled condition.

FIG. 2B is a front view of the example license plate holder of FIG. 1 in an assembled condition.

FIG. 3 is an example bottom view of the example license plate holder of FIGS. 1-2B.

FIG. 4 is an example top view of the example license plate holder of FIGS. 1-3.

FIG. 5 is an example rear perspective view of the example license plate holder of FIGS. 1-4.

FIG. 6 is an example rear view of the example license plate holder of FIGS. 1-5.

FIGS. 7A-7B are, respectively, example right side and left side views of the example license plate holder of FIGS. 1-6.

FIG. 8 is a front view of a variation of the example license plate holder of FIG. 1.

The figures are not necessarily to scale. Wherever possible, the same reference numbers will be used throughout the drawing(s) and accompanying written description to refer to the same or like parts. As used herein, stating that any part is in any way positioned on (e.g., positioned on, located on, disposed on, etc.) another part, indicates that the referenced part is either in contact with the other part, or that the referenced part is above the other part with one or more intermediate part(s) located therebetween. Stating that any part is in contact with another part means that there is no intermediate part between the two parts.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

In some aspects, this disclosure relates to an example license plate holder for vehicles, inclusive of road vehicles (e.g., cars, trucks, motorcycles, scooters, etc.), off-road vehicles (e.g., 3-wheelers, all-terrain vehicles, four wheel-

ers, etc.), and marine vehicles (e.g., boats), which require registration with a governmental body and display of a license plate on the vehicle.

FIG. 1 is an exploded perspective view of an example license plate holder 100 in accord with at least some of the present concepts. The example license plate holder 100 is shown to include, from left-to-right, an example transmissive substrate 120, an example frame 140 and an example base 200. An optional example license plate 160 is also shown in relation to the example license plate holder 100 for contextual illustration to show an example integration of a license plate 160 with a license plate holder 100 in accord with at least some aspects of the present concepts.

The example transmissive substrate 120 may include, for instance, but is not limited to, a substrate of glass, treated or strengthened glass (e.g., Gorilla Glass (Corning), Dragontrail (AGC Inc.), Xensation (Schott AG)), Plexiglass (e.g., Lucite, Acrylite, Perspex, Oroglass Optix, Altuglass, etc.), polycarbonate, acrylic (e.g., injection molded acrylic or polymethyl methacrylate, polystyrene or poly(methyl methacrylate) (PMMA)). In some examples, the example transmissive substrate 120 is a uniform substrate of a selected material. In some examples, the example transmissive substrate 120 includes a plurality of different regions such as an example first region 126 (e.g., a central region) having a first set of characteristics (e.g., optical properties such as refractive index, transmission/transmittance, absorption, mechanical properties such as Young's modulus, surface finish, strength, hardness, impact resistance, chemical resistance, etc.), an example second region 122 (e.g., a peripheral region) having a second set of characteristics, and an example third region 128 having a third set of characteristics. In some examples, two regions may have the same characteristics (e.g., the example first region 126 and the example third region 128). In the example transmissive substrate 120 shown in FIG. 1, the example first region 126 generally corresponds in size to a display area (e.g., a DIN 1451 license plate number) of an example license plate (e.g., example license plate 160) to be incorporated into the example license plate holder 100 (e.g., a United States license plate, a European license plate, a Chinese license plate, etc.). For instance, in some examples, the example first region 126 is less than 12.0"×6.0" (305 mm×152 mm) for a United States license plate, less than 20.5"×4.3" (520 mm×110 mm) for a license plate of some European countries, or 17.3"×5.5" (440 mm×140 mm) for a Chinese license plate. In some examples, the example first region 126 is a cutout in the example transmissive substrate 120.

In some examples, the third example third region 128 is optionally omitted. In some examples, the example transmissive substrate 120 includes the third example third region 128, as may be required in jurisdictions requiring the display of an additional emblem or sticker (e.g., a governmental vehicle registration sticker, etc.). The example third region 128 may alternatively be sized differently (e.g., larger, smaller, etc.) and/or disposed in another location on the example transmissive substrate 120 to comport with sizing and/or location requirements of any particular jurisdiction. For instance, the example third region 128 may be disposed in a location other than shown in the example of FIG. 1, such as in an upper left portion of the example transmissive substrate 120 or in an upper center portion of the example transmissive substrate 120. In some examples, the example third region 128 is a cutout in the example transmissive substrate 120. In some examples, two example third regions 128 may be provided, such as to permit the display of two emblems or stickers.

The example frame 140 defines an example central opening 142 to permit display of indicia, such as the license plate number, on an example first license plate display region 162. In some examples, such as is shown in FIG. 1, the example central opening 142 opens into, or is contiguous to, an example secondary opening 143 adjacent the example central opening 142. In some examples, the example central opening 142 is a distinct opening separate from that of the example secondary opening 143. As noted above, in some examples, the third example third region 128 is optionally omitted where there are no jurisdictional requirements for the display of an additional emblem or sticker (e.g., a governmental vehicle registration sticker, etc.), at an example second license plate display region 164, in an offset position from the example first license plate display region 162. In such examples, the secondary opening 143 may likewise be omitted. In other examples, the example secondary opening 143 may alternatively be sized differently (e.g., larger, smaller, etc.) and/or disposed in another location on the example frame 140 to comport with sizing and/or location requirements of any particular jurisdiction. For instance, the example secondary opening 143 may be disposed in a location other than shown in the example of FIG. 1, such as in an upper left portion of the example frame 140 or in an upper center portion of the example frame 140.

In some examples, the example central opening 142 is less than about 305 mm×152 mm (12.0"×6.0") and is sized so as not to obscure a first license plate display region 162 (e.g., a license plate number) for a United States vehicle license plate. In some examples, the example central opening 142 is less than about 520 mm×110 mm (20.5"×4.3") and is sized so as not to obscure a first license plate display region 162 (e.g., a license plate number) for a vehicle license plate in some European countries. Likewise, in other examples, the example central opening 142 is less than about 305 mm×152 mm (12.0"×6.0"), 305 mm×160 mm (12.0"×6.3"), 372 mm×135 mm (14.6"×5.3"), 440 mm×120 mm (17.3"×4.7"), 300 mm×80 mm (11.8"×3.1"), or 440 mm×140 mm (17.3"×5.5").

The example frame 140 further defines one or more example frame display regions 146 adjacent the example central opening 142. In the example of FIG. 1, the example frame 140 is shown to define a plurality of frame display regions 146, more particularly, four example frame display regions 146. The example frame 140 of FIG. 1 includes an example bottom frame display region 146 below an example bottom edge of the central opening 142, an example first lateral frame display region 146 adjacent an example first lateral edge of central opening 142, an example second lateral frame display region 146 adjacent an example second lateral edge of central opening 142, or an example upper frame display region 146 above an example top edge of the central opening 142. The one or more example frame display regions 146 include text and/or graphics, which are generically represented in FIG. 1 by fields or arrays of "X" indicia. In some examples, one or more of the example frame display region(s) 146 include(s) user-selectable text or graphics (e.g., selected from a list of options provided on a website, custom printed, etc.), such as may be associated with sports team logos, organizations, colleges or universities, companies, phrases, causes, etc.).

The example frame 140 of FIG. 1 defines a plurality of contiguous walls including an example first wall 141, an example second wall 145, an example third wall 148 and an example fourth wall 149. The example walls 141, 145, 148, 149 extend forwardly to define a first volume (not numbered) at the front of the example frame 140 to receive the

example transmissive substrate 120. The example walls 141, 145, 148, 149 also extend rearwardly to define a second volume (not numbered) at the rear of the example frame 140 to receive the example license plate 160 and the example base 200. In some examples, the example walls 141, 145, 148, 149 extend both forwardly and rearwardly. In some examples, a first set of walls extends forwardly and a second set of walls extends rearwardly.

While a plurality of example walls 141, 145, 148, 149 are shown in the example frame 140 of FIG. 1, a lesser number of walls could be provided and/or the configuration of the walls altered. For instance, while not a presently preferred example, the example walls 141, 145, 148, 149 could extend rearwardly, but not forwardly. Instead of the example transmissive substrate 120 being received within the first volume defined by the example walls 141, 145, 148, 149, the example transmissive substrate 120 could instead positively connect to the example frame 140 via a plurality of male (or female) connectors (e.g., snap fit connectors, etc.) formed on the example transmissive substrate 120 to matingly engage with correspondingly configured and positioned female (or male) connectors formed on the example frame 140. In another example, the example transmissive substrate 120 is connected to the example frame 140 via a plurality of mechanical fasteners (e.g., screws, etc.).

In yet another example the frame 140 could include a subset of the walls of FIG. 1, such as only wall 149 or only wall 148. In such example, as shown in FIG. 8, the example transmissive substrate 120 could positively connect to the example frame 140 via a plurality of male (or female) connectors 147A (e.g., snap fit connectors, etc.) formed on the example transmissive substrate 120 to matingly engage with correspondingly configured and positioned female (or male) connectors formed on the example frame 140 or, could positively connect to the example frame 140 via a plurality of mechanical fasteners (e.g., screws, etc.).

The example frame 140 includes one or more front connector(s) to removably attach the example transmissive substrate 120 to the front of the example frame 140. In the example of FIG. 1, the example frame 140 includes four example front connectors 147 disposed adjacent a front of the example frame 140. The four example front connectors 147 are cantilevered snap-fit connectors, having a head that is chamfered or tapered at a top surface, to facilitate biasing of the heads away from the first volume upon movement of the example transmissive substrate 120 into the first volume, wherein lateral edges of the example transmissive substrate 120 contact the chamfered or tapered top surfaces of the heads of the example front connectors 147 and slightly bias the heads outwardly. Following passage of the example transmissive substrate 120 into the first volume and past a bottom surface of the head, where it no longer outwardly biases the heads of the example front connectors 147, the heads return to their initial positions and lower surfaces of the heads facilitate retention of the example transmissive substrate 120 within the first volume. For instance, in some examples, the lower surfaces of the heads of the example front connectors 147 are at flat and are at least substantially parallel to the front surface of the example transmissive substrate 120 such that the heads would have to be manually or digitally biased outwardly to facilitate removal of the example transmissive substrate 120. While four example front connectors 147 are shown, a greater number (e.g., five, six, etc.) or a lesser number (e.g., one, two, three) could alternatively be implemented in the example frame 140. Likewise, different forms of example front connectors 147 (e.g., male/female connectors, mechanical connectors, fas-

5

teners, etc.) may be implemented to facilitate removable attachment of the example transmissive substrate **120** to the example frame **140**.

In some examples, the example frame **140** includes example openings **144**. In some examples of the present concepts, the example openings **144** are omitted.

FIG. **1** also shows an example license plate **160**, which may be formed from a variety of materials, such as plastic or metal (e.g., aluminum, steel, an alloy, etc.) or, in some instances, from card stock (e.g., a temporary tag). The example license plate **160** includes an example first license plate display region **162** for display of a license plate number and additional relevant information (e.g., a state of issuance, a state motto, etc.) and an example second license plate display region **164** for display of an emblem or a sticker (e.g., a governmental vehicle registration sticker, etc.) that may be required in a given jurisdiction. In some examples, a third license plate display region (not shown) may be required, similar to that of the example second license plate display region **164**, in jurisdictions requiring a second emblem or a sticker. The example license plate **160** includes a plurality of example through holes **165** to receive example mechanical fasteners **150** (e.g., screws, etc.) to secure the example license plate **160** to the example base **200** and/or to the vehicle itself which bears the example license plate holder **100**.

As discussed further in relation to FIGS. **2-7B** below, the example frame **140** includes one or more rear connectors (not shown in FIG. **1**) disposed adjacent a rear of the example frame **140** to removably attach the rear of the example frame **140** to the example base **200**.

As noted above, the example license plate **160** may include any dimension specified by any jurisdiction including, but not limited to, for example, 305 mm×152 mm (12.0"×6.0"), 520 mm×110 mm (20.5"×4.3"), or 440 mm×140 mm (17.3"×5.5") to name but a few examples.

The example base **200** of FIG. **1** includes an example central section **202**, an example first lateral section **203**, and an example second lateral section **204**. Formed within the example central section **202** are one or more example first connectors **205** (e.g., through holes, bosses, male connectors, female connectors, etc.) for attaching the example base **200** to a vehicle. The example central section **202** is recessed relative to the example first lateral section **203** and the example second lateral section **204** to define a recessed volume within which the example license plate **160** may be received. The recessed volume of the example central section **202** has an area sufficient to receive an example license plate **160** of a jurisdiction of relevance (e.g., greater than about 305 mm×152 mm (12.0"×6.0") in the United States, greater than about 440 mm×140 mm (17.3"×5.5") in China, etc.). In some examples, the example central section **202**, the example first lateral section **203**, and the example second lateral section **204** are substantially planar and the example first lateral section **203** and the example second lateral section **204** do not define a recessed volume therebetween.

The exploded view of FIG. **1** shows, beneath the example base **200**, example rear connectors **210** (e.g., mechanical fasteners, etc.) and example adapters **215** (e.g., anchors, anti-rotation anchors, etc.). The example rear connectors **210**, discussed further below in relation to FIGS. **3** and **5-6**, are inserted through corresponding openings in the example frame **140** and the example base **200** to secure a lower portion of the example frame **140** to a lower portion of the example base **200**. In some examples, the example adapters **215** are inserted only into the example base **200**. In some examples, the example adapters **215** are inserted through the

6

example frame **140** and into the example base **200**. In some examples, the example adapters **215** are omitted.

FIG. **2A** is a perspective view of the example license plate holder **100** of FIG. **1** in an assembled condition and FIG. **2B** is a front view of the example license plate holder **100** of FIG. **1** in an assembled condition. FIGS. **2A-2B** show the alignment of the example transmissive substrate **120** within the first volume of the example frame **140** and the alignment of the example frame **140** relative to the example license plate **160** and the example base **200** (not shown in FIGS. **2A-2B**). FIGS. **2A-2B** show that the example frame display regions **146** are viewable through, and protected by, the example transmissive substrate **120**. FIGS. **2A-2B** also show that the example first license plate display region **162** is viewable through the example first region **126** of the example transmissive substrate **120** and the example central opening **142** of the example frame **140**. Likewise, FIGS. **2A-2B** also show that the example second license plate display region **164** is viewable through the example third region **128** of the example transmissive substrate **120** and the example secondary opening **143** of the example frame **140**.

FIG. **3** is an example bottom view of the assembled example license plate holder **100** of FIGS. **2A-2B**, with the example front **300** of the example frame **140** and the example rear **302** of the example frame **140** being shown. FIG. **3** shows an example first boss **310** formed on a first side of the example wall **149** or bottom portion of the example frame **140** and an example second boss **312** formed on a second side of the example wall **149** of the example frame **140**. FIG. **3** also shows an example first boss **310** formed on a first side of the example wall **149** or bottom portion of the example frame **140** and an example second boss **312** formed on a second side of the example wall **149** of the example frame **140**. The example first boss **310** aligns with (e.g., is at least substantially coaxial with) an example third boss **615** (not shown in FIG. **3**) formed on a first side of an example bottom portion **249** of the example base **200**. The example second boss **312** aligns with (e.g., is at least substantially coaxial with) an example fourth boss **616** (not shown in FIG. **3**) formed on a second side of an example bottom portion **249** of the example base **200**. Each of the example first boss **310** and the example second boss **312** include an example through hole **311** to facilitate receipt of the example mechanical fastener **250**, which connects the example first boss **310** and the example second boss **312** of the example frame **140** with, respectively, the example third boss **615** and the example fourth boss **616** of the example base **200**.

FIG. **4** is an example top view of the assembled example license plate holder **100** of FIGS. **2A-3**. FIG. **4** shows a top view of an example first upper rear connector **410** and an example second upper rear connector **412**, which are shown more fully in FIGS. **5-6**.

FIG. **5** is an example rear perspective view of the example license plate holder **100** of FIGS. **1-4** in the assembled condition and FIG. **6** is an example rear view of the example license plate holder **100** of FIGS. **1-5**. At the upper end of the assembled example license plate holder **100**, FIGS. **5-6** show the example first upper rear connector **410** engaging the example ledge **710** of the example first lateral section **203** of the example base **200**. FIGS. **5-6** also show the example second upper rear connector **412** engaging the example ledge **712** of the example second lateral section **204** of the example base **200**. In some examples, the example ledges **710**, **712** correspond to an upper portion of a recess formed in a rear portion of the example first lateral section **203** and example second lateral section **204**, respectively. In

7

other examples, the rear surface of the example base **200** may be substantially planar and the example ledges **710**, **712** may be formed to extend rearwardly therefrom.

Even in isolation (i.e., without the example rear connectors **210**), the example first upper rear connector **410** and the example second upper rear connector **412** provide positive engagement with, and lockup of, the example frame **140** and the example base **200**.

In FIGS. **5-6**, the example mechanical fasteners **150** (e.g., screws, etc.) are shown to protrude through the example first connectors **205** (e.g., through holes, bosses, male connectors, female connectors, etc.) of the example base **200** and, in an installed condition, would connect the example license plate holder **100** to a vehicle.

The right example rear connector **210**, in the view of FIGS. **5-6**, comprises a mechanical fastener (e.g., a screw, etc.) inserted through the example through hole **311** of the example first boss **310** of the example frame **140** and through a corresponding one of the example adapters **215**, which is in turn through or received by the example third boss **615** of the example base **200**. The left example rear connector **210**, in the view of FIGS. **5-6**, comprises a mechanical fastener (e.g., a screw, etc.) inserted through the example through hole **313** of the example second boss **312** of the example frame **140** and through a corresponding one of the example adapters **215**, which is itself inserted into or received by the example fourth boss **616** of the example base **200**.

While the view of FIGS. **5-6** shows the example first lateral section **203** and the example second lateral section **204** of the example base **200** to define recesses on the rear of the example base **200**, in other examples the example first lateral section **203** and the example second lateral section **204** are solid and the example third boss **615**, the example fourth boss **616**, and the example adapters **215** are omitted in favor of holes (e.g., threaded holes, etc.) to receive the example rear connectors **210**. In some examples, rather than two example rear connectors **210** disposed at or near a first and a second lateral end of the example frame **140** and the example base **200**, a single centrally disposed rear connector **210** is used to secure a lower portion of the example frame **140** to a lower portion of the example base **200**.

FIGS. **7A-7B** are, respectively, example right side and left side views of the example license plate holder **100** of FIGS. **1-6**, showing alternate views of components of the example frame **140** including the example first upper rear connector **410**, the example second upper rear connector **412**, the example first boss **310** and the example second boss **312**.

Although certain example apparatus, articles of manufacture and methods have been disclosed herein, the scope of coverage of this patent is not limited thereto. To the contrary, this patent covers all methods, apparatus and articles of manufacture fairly falling within the scope of the claims of this patent.

What is claimed is:

1. A license plate holder, comprising:

- a frame defining a central opening to permit display of indicia on a license plate display region of a license plate and further defining at least one frame display region adjacent the central opening, the at least one frame display region being disposed adjacent and over one or more connectors attaching a license plate base to a vehicle to obscure the one or more connectors attaching the license plate base to the vehicle; and
- a transmissive substrate, the transmissive substrate comprising one or more snap-fit connectors to removably connect the transmissive substrate to a front of the

8

frame to dispose the transmissive substrate over the central opening and the at least one frame display region, the one or more snap-fit connectors configured to correspondingly engage one or more peripheral portions of the frame,

wherein, in an assembled state with the transmissive substrate disposed in front of the frame and connected to the frame, a central region of the transmissive substrate is positioned over the central opening of the frame and the license plate display region and a peripheral region of the transmissive substrate is positioned over the at least one frame display region of the frame to cover the at least one frame display region.

2. The license plate holder of claim 1, wherein the frame comprises at least one rear connector to connect the frame to the license plate base.

3. The license plate holder of claim 2, wherein the at least one rear connector comprises a snap-fit connector.

4. The license plate holder of claim 3, wherein the at least one rear connector is disposed along a first lateral portion of the frame to matingly engage a first lateral portion of the license plate base, disposed along a second lateral portion of the frame to matingly engage a second lateral portion of the license plate base, disposed along an upper portion of the frame to matingly engage an upper portion of the license plate base, or disposed along a lower portion of the frame to matingly engage a lower portion of the license plate base.

5. The license plate holder of claim 4, wherein the at least one rear connector comprises a plurality of snap-fit connectors, with at least one of the plurality of snap-fit connectors of the at least one rear connector disposed along the first lateral portion of the frame, the second lateral portion of the frame, the upper portion of the frame, or the lower portion of the frame.

6. The license plate holder of claim 5, wherein at least one snap-fit connector of the plurality of snap-fit connectors of the at least one rear connector is disposed along another one of the first lateral portion of the frame, the second lateral portion of the frame, the upper portion of the frame, or the lower portion of the frame.

7. The license plate holder of claim 6, wherein at least one snap-fit connector of the plurality of snap-fit connectors of the at least one rear connector is disposed along still another one of the first lateral portion of the frame, the second lateral portion of the frame, the upper portion of the frame, or the lower portion of the frame.

8. The license plate holder of claim 1, wherein a first region of the transmissive substrate comprises a first characteristic and a second region of the transmissive substrate comprises a second characteristic different than the first characteristic.

9. The license plate holder of claim 8, wherein the first region and the first characteristic correspond to the central region of the transmissive substrate.

10. The license plate holder of claim 9, wherein the second region and the second characteristic correspond to the peripheral region of the transmissive substrate.

11. The license plate holder of claim 9, wherein the second region and the second characteristic correspond to lateral portions of the transmissive substrate.

12. The license plate holder of claim 8, wherein the first characteristic comprises a first optical property and the second characteristic comprises a second optical property.

13. The license plate holder of claim 8, wherein the first characteristic comprises a first surface finish and the second characteristic comprises a second surface finish.

9

14. The license plate holder of claim 1, wherein the at least one frame display region includes at least one of text or graphics.

15. The license plate holder of claim 14,
wherein the at least one of text or graphics comprises text, 5
graphics, or text and graphics, and

wherein the text, graphics, or text and graphics are an integral part of the frame.

16. The license plate holder of claim 14, wherein the at least one of text or graphics comprises text, graphics, or text 10
and graphics printed on, or applied to, the frame.

17. The license plate holder of claim 1, wherein the at least one frame display region comprises a plurality of frame display regions, comprising a first frame display region 15
provided at one of a first lateral portion of the frame, a second lateral portion of the frame, an upper portion of the frame, or a lower portion of the frame, and a second frame display region provided at another one of the first lateral

10

portion of the frame, the second lateral portion of the frame, the upper portion of the frame, or the lower portion of the frame.

18. The license plate holder of claim 1,
wherein the one or more connectors attaching the license plate base to the vehicle comprise a plurality of through holes dimensioned to receive mechanical fasteners, and wherein the at least one frame display region is disposed, in an assembled state with the frame positioned over the license plate base, to cover and obscure the plurality of through holes and mechanical fasteners received therein.

19. The license plate holder of claim 1,
wherein the transmissive substrate comprises a first opening to receive a mechanical fastener, and wherein the frame further comprises a second opening to receive the mechanical fastener received with the first opening of the transmissive substrate.

* * * * *